

Sunitha Kumar Girish

Director of Production | Studio Leadership | Creative Technologist

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Profile

Creative technologist and studio leader with 20+ years building and running production organizations across AAA, licensed IP, and founder-led studios, including two companies built and run from 0 to ship as sole executive (Laughing Buddha Games, Budai Labs). Track record spans leading globally distributed teams of up to 18 people across five countries, partnering directly with external platform owners (Epic Games) to build creator tooling from scratch, and operating across five distinct commercial models: AAA console, licensed IP, social/casual, platform, and founder-led indie. MSc in Computer Software Engineering; active coder with hands-on fluency in Unity, Unreal Engine/UEFN, and proprietary tooling. Agile/Scrum certified with daily use of Jira and Confluence.

Leadership Highlights

- Founded and ran two companies end to end, Laughing Buddha Games and Budai Labs, owning product, team, and commercial direction.
- Built production tooling and creator infrastructure from 0 to 1 three times: LEGO Brick Editor (with Epic Games), the AI-powered Production Canvas tool, and BudAI's Shopify agency tooling.
- Led teams ranging from 8-person cross-functional pods to an 18-person team distributed across five countries, through both founder-stage ambiguity and AAA-scale structure.
- Operated across five different commercial models (AAA console, licensed IP, social/casual, platform, founder-led indie), giving range that most single-track producers don't have.

Core Skills

Production & Methodology: Agile/Scrum leadership, sprint planning, backlog and roadmap ownership, risk management, dependency tracking, milestone delivery, incremental delivery, requirements gathering, scoping, stakeholder management

Tools: Jira, Confluence, Unity, Unreal Engine (UEFN), Roblox Studio, Git

Technical Fluency: Game engine pipelines, DevOps and CI workflows, test-driven development principles, technical risk assessment, cross-engine production (Unity, UEFN, proprietary tools)

Studio Leadership & Strategy: Founder/CEO-level ownership (P&L, fundraising conversations, team building from 0), multi-business-model fluency, IP strategy, partner negotiation, organizational design

Leadership: Cross-functional team leadership, coaching and mentoring, external partner management (Epic Games, Nintendo, SuperCell, and 10-plus other external partners), global distributed teams, AAA and live-service production

Professional Experience

Lead Producer, LEGO GAME

May 2026 – Present

The LEGO Group, Billund, Denmark

- Lead cross-functional delivery of LEGO digital play experiences on Roblox, from concept through launch.
- Designed and piloted an AI-powered Production Canvas tool spanning journey mapping, data forecasting, GDD gap tracking, dependency mapping, session-time validation, and risk heatmapping; validated the framework on a live Roblox production ahead of a wider rollout decision.

Lead Producer, Creator Experiences, LEGO GAME

Jun 2025 – May 2026

The LEGO Group, Billund, Denmark

- Led an 8-person cross-functional team through a 2 to 3 month concept-to-ship cycle for UEFN creator tooling improvements, coordinating sign-off across Epic Games, Legal, Marketing, and Brand Governance.
- Co-shipped Ninja Sushi Chaos, a joint UEFN title developed in partnership with Sublab Games.

Senior Technical Product Lead, LEGO GAME*Apr 2023 – Jul 2025**The LEGO Group, Billund, Denmark*

- Partnered directly with Epic Games to lead the 0-to-1 design, build, and launch of LEGO Brick Editor, one of the first creator tooling plugins built for Unreal Engine for Fortnite (UEFN); led an 8-person team, including 4 engineers, across a 2-plus year build.
- Headed the LEGO Unity plugin team in parallel, overseeing technical delivery across two engine ecosystems.
- Handled technical onboarding and support for Atom across LEGO GAME's external partners, including TT Games, Nintendo, Blue Zoo, SuperCell, Wizards of the Coast, Ace Games, LEGOLAND Parks Shanghai, and Studio Gobo, as well as internal LEGO teams.

Executive Committee Member*Jun 2022 – Apr 2023**Singapore Games Association (SGGA), Singapore*

- Shaped industry strategy and advocacy initiatives for Singapore-based studios, publishers, and investors as part of the executive committee.

Associate Producer*Apr 2019 – Sep 2022**Ubisoft Singapore*

- Led delivery of progression, economy, onboarding, and world systems content for Skull and Bones (AAA), coordinating an 18-person team distributed across Chengdu, Berlin, Paris, Singapore, and Ukraine through to gold release.
- Ran Scrum-based delivery across design, engineering, and art disciplines, managing milestone risk and cross-studio dependencies on a global production.

Creative Director and Co-Founder*Mar 2011 – Apr 2019**Laughing Buddha Games, Clayton, CA*

- Founded and ran a children's games studio end to end, owning product strategy, fundraising conversations, team building, and commercial decisions as sole executive; shipped StarSmasher on iOS, Amazon, and Google Play.
- Designed and led development of Athena, an AR/VR edtech sandbox prototype showcased at 500 Startups.
- Co-wrote and co-directed the VR film Hito.
- Awarded Best Female Indie, Casual Connect Asia 2013; Top 10 Nominee, Indie Showcase, Casual Connect Asia 2013.

Principal Engineer and Founder*Aug 2017 – Apr 2019**Budai Labs (first iteration), Singapore*

- Founded and ran a certified Shopify Expert agency as sole executive, owning client acquisition, delivery, and product direction; delivered 50-plus bespoke e-commerce stores.
- Accepted into Facebook FBStart 2017 Bootstrap Track; developed BudAI Messenger chatbot and BudAI Bazaar marketplace.

Senior Project Manager*Feb 2010 – Apr 2010**PopCap Games, Seattle, WA*

- Led the Facebook integration of Bejeweled Blitz, contributing to a title that scaled to 10 million-plus monthly active users and over 1 billion sessions played.

Program Manager*Feb 2006 – Jan 2009**Microsoft, Redmond, WA*

- Part of a 20-person team delivering Windows Gaming Platform features across Windows 98, 2000, XP, and 7.
- Designed and shipped the externally-facing Games Explorer statistics API for the DirectX SDK.

Software Developer*Aug 2003 – Feb 2005**Electronic Arts, Redwood City, CA*

- Provided technical game support and improved data pipelines through software automation.
- Developed and shipped EasyInfo on Sims 4; built a browser plugin prototype for the Pogo team.

Education

Oxford Executive Leadership Programme, Said Business School, University of Oxford

MSc, Computer Software Engineering, Golden Gate University, San Francisco, CA

BA, English Language and Literature, Saint Mary's College of California, Moraga, CA

Professional Certifications

Scaled Scrum Expert Accredited Certification, Scrum Inc. | Agile Coach Accredited Certification, ICAgile | Scrum Product Owner Accredited Certification, Scrum Alliance | Certified ScrumMaster (CSM), Scrum Alliance

Awards and Recognition

Best Female Indie Award, Casual Connect Asia 2013 | FBStart Bootstrap Track, Facebook 2017